

ASUS ROG RAPTURE GT-AX11000 Pro

Wi-Fi 6 in its final avatar

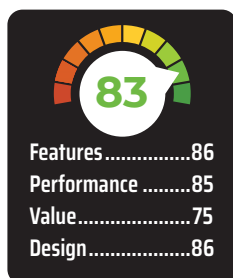
The ASUS ROG Rapture GT-AX11000 Pro represents a significant evolution from its predecessor, the GT-AX11000. Launched over three years ago, the GT-AX11000 marked ASUS's foray into Wi-Fi 6 technology and was one of the top-performing routers to have graced the Digit Test Labs. However, that was when Wi-Fi 6 was just starting out and the standard had not been completely fleshed out. The GT-AX11000 Pro, however, stands as a culmination of this journey, offering advanced features and potentially marking the zenith of ASUS's Wi-Fi 6 hardware. Why the zenith? Notably, it supports the UNII-4 section of the 5GHz spectrum, a rare addition among Wi-Fi 6 routers. This gives it an additional chunk of the wireless spectrum without having to share it with anything else. We'll elaborate more on this later.

WHAT'S IN THE BOX

Unboxing the GT-AX11000 Pro, users will find the hefty router itself with all the antennae pre-attached. Underneath the router lies the accessory box which has the power adapter, power cables and a network cable. The power adapter is also quite large, almost like the ones that ship with laptops these days. Then there are a bunch of guides, warranty statements and legal declarations. As usual, the packaging of the GT-AX11000 Pro also screams premium.

BUILD

The GT-AX11000 Pro maintains the square design familiar to users of its predecessors but with several changes.



The non-removable antennas, capable of rotating and opening approximately 300 degrees, offer a blend of flexibility and durability. However, we've always preferred routers with removable antennae since they allow easy replaceability.

The underside of the ROG RAPTURE GT-AX11000 Pro has large rubberised pads to keep the device stable and prevent it from slipping. However, we noticed that it does not come with any slots for wall-mounting. The ideal configuration and placement for such routers is always mid-way between the floor and the ceiling and placed on its feet. However, for someone paying a premium and not getting the mounting holes can be a downer.

The sides have all the I/O ports for the router. On one side we see four 1 GbE ports along with one 2.5 GbE port for the WAN. Situated a little away from the LAN ports is the 10 GbE WAN port. So for folks setting up a high bandwidth network infrastructure, this is a nice router to consider.

As mentioned previously, the router has a square design with one of the corners cut. The cut corner is where all the remaining I/O ports are. This has the socket for the power input, a power switch and two USB ports. One of the USB ports is blue, signifying support for USB 3.2 standard.

The top-side of the router has a massive ROG logo emblazoned across the face with ventilation slits taking up an entire corner. There are also slits on most of the sides. The bottom edge of the top-side has all the indicator LEDs arranged in a neat straight line.

Being a top of the line router does usually mean RGB and the ROG RAPTURE GT-AX11000 Pro has support for ASUS' very own Aura RGB light. This is not the first time we are seeing RGB lighting on ASUS routers, it's just that they now boast more intricate patterns, adding a touch of visual flair. You can turn it off if you so desire.

FEATURES

At its core, the GT-AX11000 Pro is a tri-band Wi-Fi 6 router, equipped with a 2.0 GHz quad-core CPU and ASUS's new RangeBoost Plus technology. RangeBoost Plus claims to use multiple antennae to identify the best possible combination of antennae to use for higher throughput and coverage. It's mostly marketing mambo-jumbo since the base Wi-Fi protocol does most of this on its own.

The ROG RAPTURE GT-AX11000 Pro supports virtual LAN so if you want to set up smaller networks within your main network, then VLAN allows you to do so. It's not something a lot of people will use but it's always good to have the option to do so.

Coming to the inclusion of UNII-4 that we teased earlier. This is a significant improvement from a stability perspective. UNII-4 is one of the frequency ranges available for devices on the 5 GHz band. There's UNII-1, 2, 2e, 3, and 4. UNII-4 is part of the 5 GHz band but it was never allowed for Wi-Fi devices. It was reserved for the auto industry and they never used it so